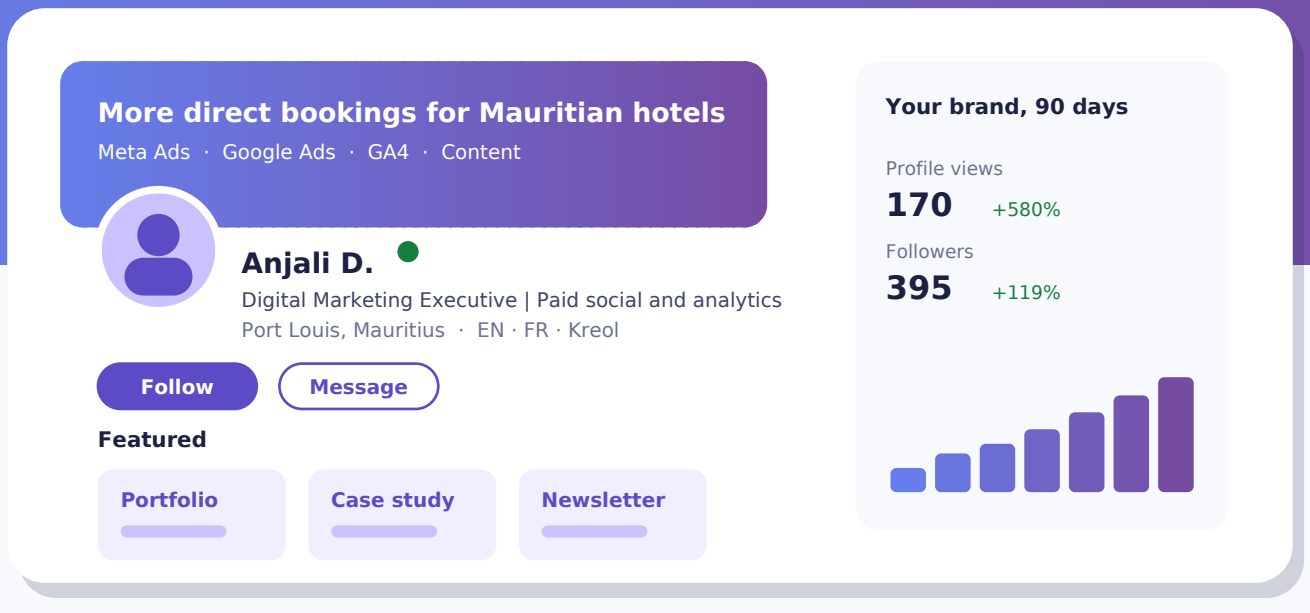
WEEK 19 · DIGITAL MARKETING & AI BOOTCAMP

Personal Branding & Career

Build your brand, optimise LinkedIn,
lead with content and grow your career

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PART A

Foundations

What a personal brand is, why it matters, and how to define your niche, positioning and statement

SECTION 1

What a personal brand is

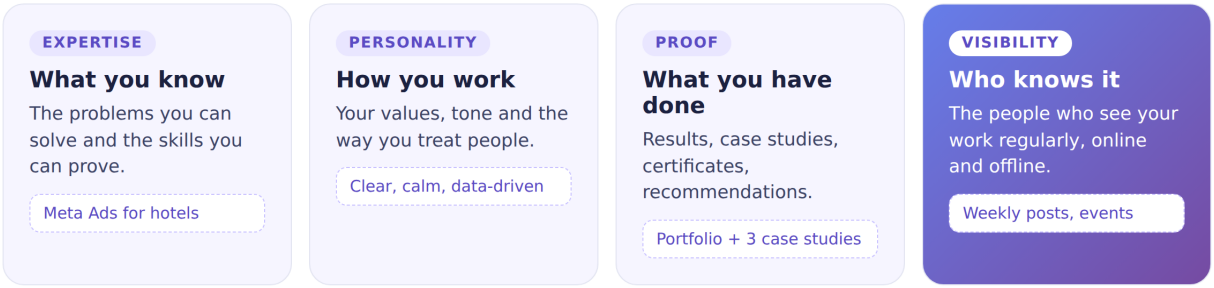
Your personal brand is the reputation you have with the people who matter to your career: what they think of when they hear your name, what they would recommend you for, and what they find when they search for you. You already have one. This week is about building it on purpose, honestly, and in a way you can keep up.

Where this week fits

For 18 weeks you have built brands for businesses: positioning and storytelling in **Week 4**, company pages and social strategy in **Week 5**, ads, analytics, email, automation and AI tools after that. In **Week 13** you learnt to use AI assistants with the C.A.R.E. framework. This week you apply the same tools to the most important "client" you will ever have: **yourself**. The deliverable is your **Personal Brand Strategy**, including a 4-week thought-leadership content plan.

What a personal brand is made of

What people say about you when you are not in the room: four ingredients you can build on purpose



Personal brand vs business brand

	Business brand (Weeks 4–5)	Personal brand (this week)
Who it represents	A company, product or service	One person: you
Main platforms	Facebook and Instagram pages, website, Google Business Profile	LinkedIn profile, portfolio, events, word of mouth
Voice	Agreed brand voice, often written by a team	Your own voice, opinions and experience
Goal	Sales, bookings, enquiries	Job offers, clients, partnerships, trust, influence
Biggest risk	Inconsistency, bad reviews	Faking it, oversharing, disappearing after 3 weeks
What it needs most	Budget and planning	Time, consistency and proof

Three myths to drop

Myth	Reality
"Personal branding is showing off."	Good personal branding is **being useful in public**: teaching, sharing lessons, helping. People remember the helpers.
"I need to be an expert first."	You need to be **one step ahead** of the people you help. A bootcamp graduate can teach a cake-shop owner how to read Instagram insights.
"I need thousands of followers."	In Mauritius, 300 of the right people (recruiters, agency owners, SME managers in your niche) matter more than 10,000 strangers.
"It is only for extroverts."	Writing is one of the best channels for quiet people. You choose the format and the rhythm.

> **The definition we use in this guide:** a personal brand is a clear, consistent and proven answer to the question "What are you the person for?", made visible to the right people.

SECTION 2

Why it matters in Mauritius and remotely

Mauritius is a small, connected market where reputation travels fast. At the same time, digital marketing skills can be sold to clients in Réunion, France, the UK, Africa and beyond. A visible personal brand helps in both directions.

The numbers behind LinkedIn in Mauritius

Indicator (late 2025)	Value	What it means for you
LinkedIn members in Mauritius	630,000	A large share of the working population has a profile, including recruiters and managers.
LinkedIn ad reach vs total population	49.7%	Roughly half the population appears in LinkedIn's audience figures.
LinkedIn ad reach vs adults (18+)	60.8%	Most adults you want to reach professionally are on the platform.
Internet users	1.01 million (79.5%)	Your name will be searched online before most meetings.

Source: DataReportal, Digital 2026: Mauritius. LinkedIn counts registered members, not monthly active users, so not all of these people use it every week.

Why a personal brand helps

- **Hiring starts with a search.** Recruiters and agency owners look at your LinkedIn profile, and often Google you, before they call. An empty profile looks like no experience.
- **Small market, strong word of mouth.** In Mauritius many jobs and freelance contracts are filled through recommendations. A brand makes it easy for people to recommend you for something specific.
- **Career changers need proof.** If your CV says "bank teller", your portfolio and posts are what show you can now run a Meta campaign or a GA4 report.
- **Remote work and export of skills.** Mauritian marketers work for clients in Europe and Africa, often in French and English. Your online presence is your shop window across time zones.
- **Business owners sell more when they are visible.** Customers trust a guesthouse, a gym or a training centre more when they know the person behind it.

- **AI makes generic skills cheaper.** When anyone can produce a caption, employers pay for judgement, results and trust. Those are exactly what a personal brand shows.

> **In Mauritius:** people often know each other through family, school, church, temple or mosque, sports clubs and former colleagues. Your offline reputation and your online brand must tell the same story. Being reliable, polite and on time at a networking event in Ebène or a workshop in Port Louis is part of your personal brand.

Who this guide is for

You are…	Your brand goal	Focus on sections
A career changer looking for a first marketing job	Show skills and potential; get interviews	3–12, 19–22
An employee wanting promotion or a better role	Become known for a specialism; attract offers	4–11, 13–18
A business owner	Build trust in your business through your own voice	4–5, 13–18, 25
A future freelancer or consultant	Attract clients, justify your prices	4–12, 23–24

SECTION 3

Self-audit: where you stand today

Before you write a headline or a post, find out what you really have to offer and how you look from the outside. The self-audit takes one afternoon and gives you the raw material for everything else.



Step 1 · Strengths: ask, do not guess

Send a short message to 5 people who know your work (a former manager, a colleague, a classmate from this bootcamp, a client, a friend). Most people are happy to answer.

```
Hi Nadia, I am working on my professional profile after my digital
marketing bootcamp. Could you answer 3 quick questions honestly?
1. What do you think I am really good at?
2. When would you call me for help?
3. Three words that describe how I work?
Thank you, it really helps!
```

Look for repeated words. If three people say "organised", "clear" and "patient", that is part of your brand.

Step 2 · Values

Choose 3 values that guide how you work (for example honesty, curiosity, reliability, creativity, respect, independence). For each, write one sentence of proof: "Reliability: in 4 years at the bank I never missed a reporting deadline."

Step 3 · Skills inventory from this bootcamp

Most students underestimate how much they now know. Fill in this table honestly, with the proof you can show.

Week	Skill	Level (1–3)	Proof you can show
1–2	Digital marketing ecosystem, website basics, GA4, key events		GA4 set-up screenshots, KPI framework
3	SEO: keyword research, on-page, local SEO		SEO audit of a website
4–5	Content strategy, storytelling, social media strategy		Content calendar, social playbook
6–7	Google Ads Search: build and optimise		Campaign structure, optimisation report
8–9	Meta Ads, display, video, programmatic		Meta campaign plan, media plan
10	Email marketing and CRM		Email strategy, 5-email sequence
11–12	Advanced analytics, performance and ROAS		Data Studio dashboard, ROAS analysis
13–15	AI for content and paid media, marketing automation		AI prompt toolkit, automation system
Before	Skills from previous jobs (sales, finance, teaching, hospitality…)		Results, references

Level: 1 = I understand it, 2 = I have done it with guidance, 3 = I can do it alone for a client. Soft skills count too: presenting, writing, customer service, managing a budget, speaking French and Kreol with clients.

Step 4 · Search yourself

1. Open a private (incognito) browser window so results are not personalised.
2. Search your full name, then your name + "Mauritius", then your name + your profession.
3. Check the first page of Google results, Google Images, and the "People" results on LinkedIn.
4. Note what you find: your profiles, old photos, comments, namesakes (other people with the same name).
5. Score it: **Green** (helps you), **Neutral**, **Red** (you would not want a recruiter to see it). Deal with red items in Section 25.

> **Tip:** if you share your name with someone else, use a consistent version everywhere (for example "Anjali R. Doorgakant" or adding your middle name) and the same profile photo, so people can recognise you.

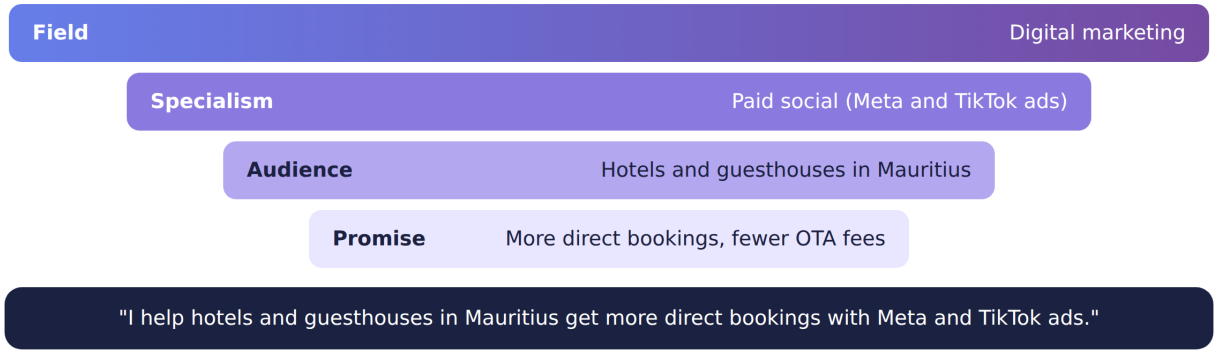
SECTION 4

Niche, audience and positioning

Positioning is the place you want to own in people's minds. "Digital marketer" is too broad to remember. "The person who helps guesthouses get direct bookings with Meta ads" is easy to remember and easy to recommend.

From broad to sharp: finding your positioning

Each step makes you easier to remember and easier to recommend



Choosing your niche: three filters

Filter	Question	Example answers
Skill	Which part of digital marketing do I enjoy and do well?	Paid social, SEO, content and copywriting, analytics, email and CRM, automation
Market	Which industry or type of client do I understand?	Tourism and hospitality, retail, finance, education, real estate, food, NGOs
Demand	Who needs this and can pay for it?	Hotels need direct bookings; SMEs need leads; schools need enrolments

You can niche by **skill** (an SEO specialist), by **industry** (marketing for restaurants) or by both. Beginners often start with an industry they already know from a previous job: a former hotel receptionist understands booking problems better than most marketers.

Define your audience

Your personal brand audience is not "everyone". List the 2–3 groups whose attention changes your career:

Audience	What they want to see	Where to reach them
Recruiters and HR managers	Clear role, skills, certificates, results, reliability	LinkedIn search, job portals, career fairs
Agency owners and marketing managers	Practical skills, curiosity, examples of work, ability to learn tools	LinkedIn posts and comments, events, referrals
SME owners (potential clients)	Simple explanations, results for businesses like theirs, prices, trust	LinkedIn, Facebook groups, business events, word of mouth
Peers and the community	Useful tips, honest lessons, collaboration	LinkedIn, alumni groups, meetups

The positioning statement (internal)

Write it for yourself first. It will guide your headline, About section and content.

```
For [audience]
who [problem or need],
I am a [role / specialism]
who [main benefit / result],
because [proof: experience, skills, certificates, results].
Unlike [the usual alternative], I [what makes you different].
```

Example (fictional): For guesthouses and small hotels in Mauritius who depend on booking platforms and their commissions, I am a paid social specialist who helps them get more direct bookings, because I worked 5 years in hotel reception and I run Meta and TikTok campaigns with GA4 tracking. Unlike general agencies, I speak the language of front office and revenue, in English and French.

Do not over-niche too early. Your niche is a starting focus, not a prison. Test it for 3 months with content and conversations; if nobody responds, adjust the audience or the promise.

SECTION 5

Brand statement and elevator pitch

Your positioning becomes two tools you will use every day: a one-sentence **brand statement** for your profile and bio, and a 30-second **elevator pitch** for events, interviews and phone calls.

The brand statement: one sentence

Formula: **I help [who] [achieve what] through/with [how].** Optional: add proof or personality.

Profile	Brand statement (fictional examples)
Career changer (ex-banking)	I help financial and insurance brands turn data into clear, compliant digital campaigns.
Graduate, social media	I help restaurants and cafés in the north of Mauritius fill tables with short videos and Instagram content.
Freelance SEO	I help Mauritian SMEs get found on Google and in AI answers with practical, local SEO.
Business owner (gym)	I help busy professionals in Quatre Bornes get fit in 3 sessions a week, and I share what I learn about running a small business.
Bilingual content	J’aide les entreprises mauriciennes à parler à leurs clients en français et en anglais, avec du contenu clair qui convertit.

The elevator pitch: 30 seconds, 4 parts

1. **Who you are:** name and role. "I am Kevin, a digital marketer specialising in Google Ads."
2. **Who you help and the problem:** "I work with small retail shops that get visits on Facebook but few sales online."
3. **How and proof:** "I set up search campaigns and tracking so they know which rupee brings which sale. On my last project, enquiries doubled in two months."
4. **The ask or the hook:** "Do you know any shop owners struggling with online sales?" or "What is your biggest marketing challenge this year?"

Adapt the pitch to the situation

Situation	Length	Change
Networking event	20–30 s	End with a question about them; do not sell immediately
Job interview ("Tell me about yourself")	60–90 s	Past → present → why this role; add one result
Client call	30 s	Focus on their problem and a similar result
LinkedIn connection note	Up to 200 characters on a free account	One line on why you are connecting

Pitch in French too

```
« Je m’appelle Sandra, je suis spécialiste en réseaux sociaux pour la
restauration. J’aide les restaurants du nord à remplir leurs tables grâce
aux vidéos courtes et à la publicité Meta. Le mois dernier, un client a
reçu 40 réservations via Instagram. Et vous, comment trouvez-vous vos
clients aujourd’hui ? »
```

Tip: practise your pitch aloud 10 times and record it on your phone. If you run out of breath or say "um" in the first sentence, shorten it. Kreol is perfectly fine in informal settings; switch language to match the person in front of you.

PART B

Your LinkedIn profile

How LinkedIn works in 2026 and how to optimise your profile, section by section, in EN and FR

SECTION 6

LinkedIn in 2026: what has changed

In Week 5 you set up and managed company pages. Your personal profile works differently: people follow and trust people more than logos. Before optimising, understand the features you will use and what has changed recently.

Profile vs company page

	Personal profile	Company page (Week 5)
Who	You, as an individual	The business
Relationships	Connections (two-way, up to 30,000) and followers	Followers only
Typical reach	Usually higher per post, because people engage with people	Lower organic reach; often supported by ads
Best for	Job search, thought leadership, networking, selling services	Employer brand, company news, ads, jobs

Recent changes you should know

Change	What it means for you
Creator mode retired (2024)	There is no longer a switch. Creator tools (follow link, newsletters, LinkedIn Live, audio events) are available from your profile's analytics and tools area, with conditions for some of them (for example a minimum audience of around 150 followers or connections for Live).
Community Top Voice badges ended (October 2024)	The gold badges for answering collaborative articles were removed. The blue **Top Voice** badge remains, chosen by LinkedIn's editorial team. You cannot apply for it; focus on useful content instead.
Native image carousels removed	A "carousel" on LinkedIn today is a **PDF uploaded as a document post**, which people swipe through.
Skills: up to 100	You can list up to 100 skills and tag up to 5 top skills in your About section.
Verification badges	Free identity verification (photo ID, through partners, mostly in the mobile app) and workplace verification by work email where the employer takes part.
AI and your data	LinkedIn has a setting called "Data for Generative AI Improvement". Check it in Settings › Data privacy and decide whether your content may be used to train AI models (Section 25).

In Mauritius: LinkedIn is the main professional network for recruiters, banks, hotel groups, BPOs, agencies and the global business sector. Many local SMEs and freelancers also find clients there, while their customers are mostly on Facebook and Instagram. A smart personal brand uses LinkedIn for professional credibility and Facebook groups or Instagram where the target audience actually is.

Before you start: 5 quick settings

☐ **Custom URL:** Edit public profile and URL → linkedin.com/in/firstname-lastname (no numbers).

☐ **Turn off update sharing** while you edit, so your network is not notified of every change (the option appears when you edit your current position or headline).

☐ **Contact info:** add a professional email, phone or WhatsApp (optional), portfolio link.

☐ **Location:** city and country (for example Port Louis, Mauritius) so local recruiters find you.

☐ **Language:** write the main profile in English; add a French profile version if you target French-speaking clients (Section 8).

SECTION 7

Photo, banner and headline

These three elements appear everywhere: in search results, next to your comments, in invitations. Together they decide whether someone clicks on your profile.

Anatomy of a strong LinkedIn profile

Top to bottom, what each block must do

1 · BANNER	A 1584 × 396 px image that says what you do (your promise, a visual of your work).
2 · PHOTO + HEADLINE	Friendly, clear face. Headline: role + who you help + result (up to 220 characters).
3 · ABOUT	Your story, what you do, proof, how to contact you. First 2–3 lines matter most.
4 · FEATURED	Your best 3–5 items: portfolio, case study, newsletter, a strong post.
5 · EXPERIENCE	Results, not duties. Include projects and the DMM & AI bootcamp work.
6 · SKILLS + CERTIFICATES	Up to 100 skills; top 5 in About; certificates with credential links.
7 · RECOMMENDATIONS	Two or three specific recommendations from clients, managers, trainers.

The order of blocks on a profile. We cover each one in Sections 7–10.

Profile photo

- Recent, clear, friendly; your face fills about 60% of the frame. Look at the camera.
- Plain or softly blurred background; daylight from a window is enough. A phone in portrait mode works.
- Dress as you would for a meeting with your target audience (smart casual for agencies, more formal for banks).
- Upload at least 400 × 400 px. Use the same photo on your CV, portfolio, WhatsApp Business and event badges.
- Avoid: sunglasses, group photos, wedding photos, heavy filters, logos instead of a face.
- AI-generated "professional headshots" can look fake or unlike you. If you use AI to clean the background, keep it recognisable; when people meet you, they should recognise you.

Banner (background image)

Size 1584 × 396 px. Design it in Canva (search "LinkedIn banner"). Keep important elements to the right half: on mobile, your photo covers the left side.

Banner idea	Example
Your promise in one line	"Helping Mauritian hotels get more direct bookings"
Your services or skills	"Meta Ads · Google Ads · GA4 · Content"

Banner idea	Example
Proof	Logos of certifications (only those you hold), a speaking photo
A call to action	"Free newsletter every Tuesday" or your website

Headline: your most important 220 characters

By default LinkedIn shows your job title. Replace it with a headline that tells people **what you do, for whom and why it matters**. Use keywords recruiters search for (digital marketing, SEO, Google Ads, Meta Ads, social media, GA4).

Three headline formulas that work

Your headline appears next to every post, comment and search result

FORMULA 1 · ROLE + NICHE

Who you are, for whom

[Role] for [audience] | [specialism] | [proof]

Digital Marketing Executive for hotels | Meta Ads and GA4 | DMM & AI certified

FORMULA 2 · PROMISE

The result you bring

I help [audience] [achieve result] with [method]

I help Mauritian SMEs get more enquiries with Google Ads and SEO

FORMULA 3 · TRANSITION

For career changers

[New role] | ex-[old field] | [bridge skill]

Digital Marketer | ex-banking | Data-driven campaigns for finance brands

Weak headline	Strong headline
Student	Digital Marketing & AI graduate | Google Ads and Meta Ads | GA4, SEO, email | Open to agency and in-house roles
Looking for opportunities	Junior Social Media Manager | Short-form video and community for restaurants and cafés | EN · FR · Kreol
Owner at FitZone	Gym owner in Quatre Bornes | Helping busy professionals train 3x a week | Sharing what I learn about growing a local business
Freelancer	Freelance SEO consultant | Local and AI search for Mauritian SMEs | Audits, content, Google Business Profile

Tip: write your headline in the language of your audience. A recruiter searching "digital marketing executive" will not find "Growth hacker ninja".

SECTION 8

The About section, in English and French

The About section (up to 2,600 characters) is your story in your own words. Only the first two or three lines show before "...see more", so start strong.

A structure that works

Part	What to write	Length
1. Hook	Who you help and the result, or a short personal line that explains your "why"	1–2 lines
2. What you do	Your services or the role you do well, in plain words	3–4 lines
3. Proof	Results, projects, certifications, tools (anonymised if needed)	3–5 bullet points
4. Personality	Values, languages, what you enjoy, how you work	1–2 lines
5. Call to action	How to contact you, what to message you about	1 line

Example in English (fictional)

```
Hotels in Mauritius pay high commissions on every booking that comes
through an online travel agency. I help them win more direct bookings.

After 5 years at hotel reception in Flic en Flac, I trained in digital
marketing (DMM & AI Bootcamp, Oreegami, 2026). Today I plan and run Meta
and Google campaigns for hospitality brands, with GA4 tracking so every
rupee is measured.

What I do:
- Meta and Instagram ads for rooms, spa and restaurant offers
- Google Ads search campaigns for direct bookings
- GA4 key events and Data Studio dashboards
- Bilingual content (EN/FR) that sounds like a real hotel, not a robot

Recent work: a test campaign for a 12-room guesthouse (anonymised) that
brought 27 direct booking enquiries in 6 weeks on a Rs 18,000 budget.

I speak English, French and Kreol. Message me if you want to talk about
direct bookings, or connect if you work in Mauritian hospitality.
```

Example in French (fictional)

```
J’aide les commerces mauriciens à transformer leurs abonnés Facebook et
Instagram en clients.

Ancienne responsable de boutique à Curepipe, je me suis formée au
marketing digital (DMM & AI Bootcamp, Oreegami, 2026). Je crée des
calendriers de contenu, des vidéos courtes et des campagnes Meta, et je
mesure les résultats avec GA4.

Compétences : stratégie social media, Meta Ads, copywriting FR/EN,
Canva, ChatGPT/Claude/Gemini, e-mailing.

Écrivez-moi si vous voulez plus de ventes en ligne, ou simplement pour
échanger sur le marketing à Maurice.
```

A second language profile

LinkedIn lets you create a profile in another language (on your profile, look for the option to add a profile in another language). Members who use LinkedIn in French then see your French version. Translate the headline, About and experience descriptions yourself or with AI, then check the result carefully (Section 18).

Top skills in About

At the end of About, choose up to 5 top skills. Pick the ones that match your positioning, for example: Meta Ads, Google Ads, Google Analytics 4, Social Media Marketing, Copywriting.

> Avoid empty buzzwords ("passionate, dynamic, results-driven"). Replace each adjective with a fact: not "results-driven" but "cut cost per lead from Rs 410 to Rs 260 in 6 weeks".

SECTION 9

Experience, skills and Featured

These sections are where recruiters and clients check if your claims are true. Show results, not duties, and make your best work one click away.

Experience: results, not duties

For each role, write 2–4 bullet points using the **Action + Task + Result** pattern. Include previous non-marketing jobs: they show transferable skills.

Duty (weak)	Result (strong)
Responsible for social media	Planned and published 3 posts a week for a Rose Hill bakery; Instagram followers grew from 1,200 to 2,050 in 4 months
Handled customer complaints	Resolved about 30 guest requests a day at front office; kept a 4.6 review score on the main booking platform
Did reporting	Built a monthly Data Studio dashboard that replaced 3 hours of manual Excel work
Bank teller	Advised 60+ customers a day on savings products; ranked top 3 in the branch for cross-selling (2024)

How to show bootcamp and project work

- Add a position such as **"Digital Marketing Trainee (project work)"** with the organisation "DMM & AI Bootcamp, Oreegami", dates, and 3–4 bullets on the projects you completed (SEO audit, Google Ads plan, email strategy, automation system).
- Or use the **Projects** section (Add profile section › Recommended › Add projects) for each major deliverable, with a link to the portfolio page.
- Never invent clients. If the business was fictional or a classmate’s, say so: "Practice project for a fictional guesthouse" is honest and still impressive.
- Freelance work: add "Freelance Digital Marketer" as a position with "Self-employed" and list anonymised results.

Skills and endorsements

- You can add up to 100 skills. Put the most relevant first and connect each skill to the experience, education or certificate where you used it.
- Use the words recruiters search for: "Search Engine Optimization (SEO)", "Google Ads", "Meta Ads", "Social Media Marketing", "Google Analytics", "Email Marketing", "Content Marketing",

"Marketing Automation", "Copywriting", "Canva".

- Ask 3–5 classmates and colleagues to endorse your top skills, and endorse theirs honestly in return.
- Remove skills that do not fit your positioning any more.

Featured: your shop window

Featured appears high on your profile and can show posts, articles, links and media. Choose 3–5 items in this order:

#	Item	Example
1	Your portfolio or website	Notion or Google Sites portfolio with 3 case studies
2	Your best case study	PDF: "Google Ads plan for a fictional car rental business"
3	A post that shows your thinking	Carousel: "7 things I learnt running my first Meta campaign"
4	Your newsletter or lead magnet	Newsletter "Marketing Maurice, every second Tuesday"
5	Your services or contact	Link to a booking page, Services page or WhatsApp Business link

> **Tip:** update Featured every quarter. An old post from two years ago at the top of your profile says "inactive".

SECTION 10

Certificates and recommendations

Certificates prove you have learnt; recommendations prove other people trust you. Both are powerful for beginners and career changers.

Adding the DMM & AI certificate

1. On your profile, click **Add profile section › Recommended › Add licenses & certifications**.
2. **Name:** the exact name on your certificate (for example "Digital Marketing & AI Bootcamp").
3. **Issuing organisation:** type "Oreegami" and select the page if it appears, so its logo shows.
4. **Issue date:** the month you received it. No expiry date unless stated.
5. **Credential ID / URL:** if your certificate has a verification link or ID, add it; otherwise upload a PDF or image of the certificate as media.
6. **Skills:** link 5–10 skills learnt (SEO, Google Ads, Meta Ads, GA4, email marketing, marketing automation, AI for content).
7. Then **share a post** about it: not "Happy to announce", but what you learnt, your favourite project and what you want to do next (template in Section 15).

Also add it to Education or Experience

Many recruiters scan Education first. You can add the bootcamp under Education (school: Oreegami; field: Digital Marketing; dates) and describe the 20-week programme and your capstone projects. Choose one place for the details and keep the others short, so the profile does not repeat itself.

Recommendations: quality over quantity

Two or three specific recommendations are worth more than ten vague ones. Ask people who saw your work: a manager, a client, a trainer, a teammate on a group project.

How to ask (make it easy)

```
Hi Mr Ramsamy, I really enjoyed working with you on the guesthouse
campaign last month. Would you be comfortable writing a short LinkedIn
recommendation? If it helps, you could mention how I set up the tracking
and the 27 enquiries we got in 6 weeks. No pressure at all, and I am
happy to write one for you too. Thank you!
```

Write good recommendations for others: context (how you worked together), a specific strength, a result, and who should hire them. People often return the favour, and your recommendation is visible on their profile with your name.

> Do not exchange fake recommendations with friends who never saw your work. Recruiters in Mauritius often call people they know at your previous workplace; a recommendation that does not match the reference call damages trust.

SECTION 11

Settings, Open to Work, Services and verification

A few features can bring opportunities to you. Use them deliberately, with an eye on privacy.

Open to Work: two options

Option	Who sees it	When to use it
Recruiters only	Recruiters using LinkedIn's paid recruiting tools; no frame on your photo. LinkedIn tries to hide it from recruiters at your own company but cannot guarantee it.	You have a job and are searching quietly
All LinkedIn members	Everyone; a green #OpenToWork frame appears on your photo	You are not employed, or your employer knows you are leaving

Fill in the job titles (up to five), locations (Mauritius, plus "Remote"), start date and type of work (full-time, part-time, contract). Both options are free.

The Services page (for freelancers)

If you sell services, add a **Services** page from your profile (Open to › Providing services). You can list several services (LinkedIn has allowed up to 10), describe them, give your location or remote work, and show pricing or "contact for pricing". Clients can send you a request for a proposal; your response time is shown, so answer quickly. You can also invite past clients to leave a review.

Verification

- **Identity verification** (free): in the LinkedIn mobile app, open your profile and look for "Verify" or "Verifications". You scan a government photo ID with a partner service; options depend on your country. A verified badge adds trust, especially for freelancers working with foreign clients.
- **Workplace verification:** if your employer participates, you can confirm your current job with your work email.
- Only verify through LinkedIn's own app or website. Never send ID photos to someone who contacts you claiming to be "LinkedIn support".

Follow button and creator tools

If you plan to post regularly, you can make **Follow** the main button on your profile instead of Connect (in Settings › Visibility, look for the followers option). People can then follow your content without you accepting every connection. Creator tools such as newsletters and LinkedIn Live are available from your profile tools when you meet the conditions.

Privacy settings to check

- ☐ Profile viewing mode (public, semi-private, private) when you research competitors or employers.
- ☐ Who can see your connections list and your email address.
- ☐ Whether you appear in search engines outside LinkedIn (Settings › Visibility › Edit your public profile).
- ☐ "Data for Generative AI Improvement" (Settings › Data privacy).
- ☐ Messaging: who can message you, and filters for spam and unwanted messages.

PART C

Portfolio and content

Show your work, build thought leadership and plan four weeks of content, with AI used well

SECTION 12

Your portfolio

A portfolio turns "I know Google Ads" into "here is a Google Ads plan I built, and here is what I learnt". For beginners and career changers it is often the deciding factor between two similar CVs.

What to include

Element	Content
Home / intro	Photo, brand statement, 3 skills, contact button
3–5 case studies	Your best projects from the bootcamp, freelance or job work
Skills and tools	Platforms you can use, certificates with links
About	Short story, languages, values
Contact	Email, LinkedIn, WhatsApp Business link, booking link

The case study structure (one page each)

Part	Questions to answer	Example (fictional)
1. Context	Who was the client? What was the situation?	12-room guesthouse in Trou aux Biches, 70% of bookings via OTAs
2. Objective	What did success look like, in numbers?	Get 20 direct booking enquiries in 6 weeks
3. Your role	What did you personally do?	Strategy, Meta campaign set-up, GA4 key events, creatives in Canva
4. Approach	Steps, channels, tools, budget	2 ad sets (couples Europe, local staycation), Rs 18,000 budget
5. Results	Numbers before/after, with honest context	27 enquiries, Rs 667 per enquiry, 9 bookings confirmed
6. Lessons	What would you do differently?	French ads outperformed English for Réunion; test earlier
7. Visuals	Screenshots (anonymised), charts, ads	Ad examples, dashboard screenshot with names hidden

Where to build it (free options)

Tool	Best for	Watch out
Notion	Fast, clean pages; easy to publish a page to the web; good for text-heavy case studies	Public link looks like notion.site unless you pay for a custom domain
Canva (website or PDF)	Visual portfolios, one-page sites, PDF case studies for Featured	Keep text readable on mobile
Google Sites	Free, simple multi-page site, works well with Google Docs and Slides	Basic design options
LinkedIn Featured + Projects	Showing work where recruiters already are	Not a full portfolio; link out to one
WordPress or a site builder (Week 2)	A professional site with your own domain, e.g. yourname.mu or .com	Costs for hosting and domain; more maintenance

Presenting results ethically

- **Get permission** before naming a client or showing their data. If you cannot, anonymise: "a 12-room guesthouse on the west coast".
- **Hide personal data** in screenshots: customer names, emails, phone numbers, ad account IDs (Data Protection Act 2017).
- **Label practice work clearly:** "Bootcamp project, fictional business, illustrative data". This is honest and still shows your method.
- **Give context to numbers:** budget, period, and what else changed. "Sales doubled" during the Christmas peak is not the same as in June.
- **Credit the team.** Say what you did and what others did.
- **Never fake screenshots** or inflate results. Employers can test you in an interview or a practical task.

SECTION 13

Thought leadership content strategy

Thought leadership means sharing useful ideas, experience and opinions so that people see you as a reliable source in your niche. It is content marketing (Week 4) applied to one person: the same goals, audience, pillars, calendar and measurement, at a human scale.

The personal content strategy on one page

Question	Your answer (example)
Goal (next 6 months)	Get a junior role in a digital agency in Ebène or Port Louis
Audience	Agency owners, marketing managers, recruiters; secondary: SME owners
Positioning	Practical paid social and analytics for tourism and retail
Pillars (3–4)	Teach (how-to), Show (projects), Opinion (trends), Person (journey)
Platforms	LinkedIn (main), Instagram (visual tips), Facebook groups (helping SMEs)
Rhythm	3 posts a week + 15 minutes of comments a day
Formats	Text posts, PDF carousels, one short video a week, monthly newsletter later
Metrics	Profile views, followers, comments, messages from target audience, interviews

The three levels of thought leadership

Level	What you share	Who can do it
1. Curator	Useful news and resources, with one line of your view	Anyone, from day one
2. Practitioner	What you did, how, what you learnt (projects, tests, mistakes)	Bootcamp graduates, juniors
3. Expert	Original frameworks, data, strong opinions, predictions	After experience and proof

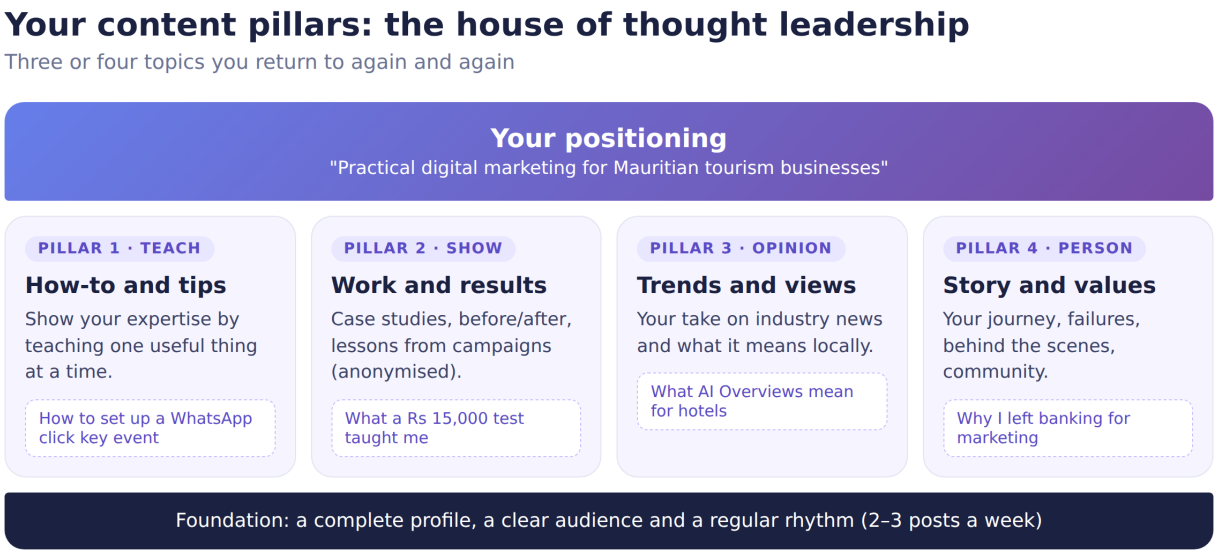
Start at level 1–2. "Here is what I learnt setting up my first GA4 key event" is credible and useful. "The 10 secrets of marketing" from a beginner is not.

In Mauritius: local content stands out. Global marketing tips are everywhere; few people explain what they mean for a guesthouse in Grand Baie, a shop in Port Louis, or for French-speaking customers in Réunion. Local examples (anonymised) and bilingual posts are a simple way to be different.

SECTION 14

Content pillars and formats

Pillars stop you from wondering "what should I post today?". They also teach your audience what to expect from you. Choose 3–4 pillars that support your positioning, then choose formats you can produce regularly.



Pillar ideas by profile

Profile	Teach	Show	Opinion	Person
Job-seeker (paid ads)	Ad set-up tips	Bootcamp campaign plans	Ads trends, AI in ads	Career change journey
SEO freelancer	Local SEO steps	Audits (anonymised)	AI answers and search	Freelance life
Business owner (guesthouse)	Travel tips for guests	Behind the scenes, team	Tourism in Mauritius	Founder story, lessons
Content creator	Canva and video tips	Before/after edits	Platform changes	Creative process

LinkedIn formats compared

Format	Good for	Effort	Tips
Text post	Stories, lessons, opinions	Low	Up to 3,000 characters; short paragraphs; strong first line
Text + image	Showing a result, a photo of an event, a chart	Low	Real photos beat stock images
PDF carousel (document)	Step-by-step guides, frameworks, checklists	Medium	5–10 slides, one idea per slide, square or 4:5
Short video	Tips, personality, explaining a screen	Medium	Subtitles, hook in 3 seconds, vertical or square
Poll	Starting a conversation, research	Low	Use rarely; always comment with your own view
Article / newsletter	Deep dives, monthly roundups	High	Start once you have a rhythm (Section 16)
Comments	Visibility with new audiences, relationships	Low	Daily habit (Section 16)

Tip: repurpose (Week 4): one bootcamp project can become a case study in your portfolio, a carousel, a text post with lessons, a 60-second video and a section of your newsletter.

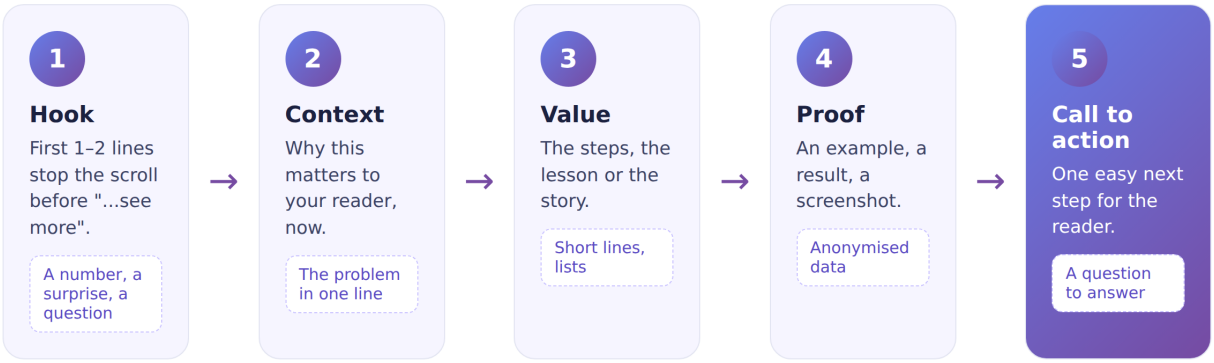
SECTION 15

Writing posts that work

Good LinkedIn writing is simple: one idea per post, written for one reader, in short lines that are easy to read on a phone. The storytelling and copywriting frameworks from Week 4 (AIDA, PAS, BAB) all work here.

The structure of a post that gets read

Five parts, whether it is a text post, a carousel or a short video



Hooks: the first line decides everything

Hook type	Example
A number or result	"Rs 18,000, 6 weeks, 27 direct booking enquiries. Here is what worked."
A surprise or contrast	"My best-performing ad was the one I almost did not publish."
A common mistake	"Most small businesses in Mauritius boost posts. Most of them waste money doing it."
A personal moment	"Six months ago I was counting cash at a bank counter."
A question	"How do you know which ad brought that WhatsApp message?"
A promise	"5 free tools I use every week as a junior marketer."

Writing rules

- **One reader, one idea.** Write as if to one person in your audience: "a guesthouse owner who boosts posts".
- **Short lines.** One to two sentences per paragraph; white space between them.
- **Specific beats general.** Numbers, names of tools, places, real situations (anonymised).
- **Show your work.** Steps, screenshots, before/after.
- **End with a question or a clear next step** that is easy to answer.
- **Hashtags:** 0–3 relevant ones are enough. Tagging people only when they are genuinely involved.
- **Links:** many creators put external links in the first comment rather than the post; test both and watch your results.
- **Language:** English reaches more recruiters; French reaches Francophone clients and Réunion. You can alternate, or write a short bilingual post.

Example post: "my bootcamp certificate" (fictional)

```
20 weeks ago I could not explain what a "key event" was.

This week I finished the Digital Marketing & AI Bootcamp (Oreegami).
Three things I did not expect:

1. Analytics was my favourite part. Seeing which ad brought which
   WhatsApp message changed how I think about marketing.
2. AI saves time, but only if you check everything it writes.
3. The hardest skill was not a tool. It was explaining results simply.

My capstone: a full Google Ads and GA4 plan for a (fictional) car
rental company in Mahébourg. The case study is in my Featured section.

Next: I am looking for a junior role in paid media, in-house or agency.

Marketers: what do you wish you had known in your first year?
```

Storytelling for personal posts

Use the simple arc from Week 4: **situation → challenge → action → result → lesson**. The lesson is what makes it thought leadership rather than a diary entry. Share failures too: "What went wrong with my first campaign" is often more useful and more trusted than a success story.

SECTION 16

Carousels, video, newsletters and comments

Once you are comfortable with text posts, add richer formats one at a time. And remember that your comments on other people's posts are content too.

PDF carousels in Canva

1. In Canva, create a design sized 1080 × 1350 px (4:5) or 1080 × 1080 px.
2. Slide 1: hook and title. Slides 2–8: one idea each, large text (at least 28–32 pt). Last slide: summary and call to action ("Save this", "Follow for more", your name).
3. Use your brand colours and the same fonts every time; add your name and photo on the first and last slides.
4. Download as **PDF Standard**. On LinkedIn, start a post and add a **document**; give it a clear title.
5. Write a short post text that explains why the carousel is useful.

Short video

- Keep it 30–90 seconds: one tip, one opinion or one quick screen demo.
- Hook in the first 3 seconds; add subtitles (most people watch without sound). CapCut or Canva can create captions automatically; check spelling.
- Natural light, phone at eye level, clear audio (a cheap clip-on microphone helps a lot).
- Post natively (upload the file) rather than sharing a YouTube link.

Newsletters

A LinkedIn newsletter is a series of articles that people subscribe to; subscribers are notified when you publish. Start one from **Write article** and the newsletter option, when it is available for your account (LinkedIn may require a minimum audience and a good-standing account). Start only when you can publish at least once a month for 6 months.

Element	Example
Name	"Marketing Maurice: practical digital marketing for local businesses"
Promise	One practical idea for Mauritian SMEs, every second Tuesday
Structure	One main topic + one tool + one local example + one question
Frequency	Every two weeks or monthly; consistent day

A comment strategy (15 minutes a day)

1. Make a list of 20–30 people and pages your audience follows (marketing managers, agency founders, local business leaders, international experts in your niche). Turn on notifications for 5–10 of them.
2. Each day, write 3–5 **thoughtful** comments: add an example, a question or a different view. Not "Great post!".
3. Comment early (first hours after a post), when more people see comments.
4. Reply to every comment on your own posts within the first hours; ask a follow-up question.
5. Thank people who share your content, and visit the profiles of new followers in your niche.

> **Tip:** a good comment is a mini-post: 2–4 lines that someone would like to read even without the original post. Many people find new connections through comments, not through their own posts.

SECTION 17

Your 4-week content plan

Your deliverable includes a 4-week thought-leadership content plan. Here is a model you can adapt: three posts a week, one theme per week, mixing pillars and formats.

A 4-week thought-leadership content plan

Three posts a week, one theme per week, daily comments in between

WEEK 1	WEEK 2	WEEK 3	WEEK 4
Introduce	**Teach**	**Prove**	**Connect**
Mon · Story: why I chose digital marketing	Mon · How-to: GA4 key events in plain words	Mon · Before/after: a profile or ad rewrite	Mon · Trend: AI and search in Mauritius
Wed · How-to: 3 checks before boosting a post	Wed · Opinion: what SMEs get wrong about ads	Wed · Lessons: 5 mistakes from my first campaign	Wed · Community: tag 3 useful local resources
Fri · Carousel: my bootcamp in 6 lessons	Fri · Case study: a fictional guesthouse plan	Fri · Short video: a 60-second tip	Fri · Recap carousel + clear offer or ask

Every day: 15 minutes of thoughtful comments on 5 posts from your target audience

The plan in detail (example for a paid-media job-seeker)

Wk	Day	Pillar	Format	Topic and hook	Goal / CTA
1	Mon	Person	Text + photo	"Six months ago I was counting cash at a bank counter."	Introduce yourself; ask about readers' career changes
1	Wed	Teach	Text	3 checks before you boost a Facebook post	Show expertise; ask for their tips
1	Fri	Show	Carousel	My bootcamp in 6 lessons	Saves; profile visits
2	Mon	Teach	Carousel	GA4 key events in plain words	Saves; comments
2	Wed	Opinion	Text	What SMEs get wrong about ads budgets	Debate; comments from owners
2	Fri	Show	PDF case study	Google Ads plan for a fictional car rental firm	Portfolio visits
3	Mon	Show	Before/after image	Rewriting a weak ad (fictional)	Engagement
3	Wed	Person	Text	5 mistakes from my first campaign	Trust, comments
3	Fri	Teach	Video 60 s	How to read the Meta Ads "Results" column	Followers
4	Mon	Opinion	Text	AI answers and search: what changes for Mauritian businesses	Comments, shares
4	Wed	Community	Text	3 free local resources for learning marketing	Goodwill, tags
4	Fri	Show / CTA	Recap carousel	What I learnt in a month of posting + I am open to roles	Messages, interviews

How to run it

- **Batch:** write the 3 posts of a week on Sunday (90 minutes). Design carousels in one Canva session.
- **Schedule:** LinkedIn allows scheduling posts (the clock icon when creating a post), or use a tool from Week 5.
- **Post time:** test early morning (7:30–8:30) and lunchtime (12:00–13:00) Mauritius time for local audiences; your own analytics decide.
- **Track** each post in a simple sheet: date, pillar, format, impressions, comments, profile views that week, messages received.
- **Review on day 28:** keep the 2 best formats and pillars, drop the weakest, plan the next 4 weeks.

SECTION 18

Using AI for your personal content

In Week 13 you learnt to prompt ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini with C.A.R.E. (Context, Action, Result, Example). For personal branding, AI is an excellent assistant for ideas, structure and editing, but a poor substitute for your own experience and voice.

Good uses and bad uses

Use AI to…	Do not use AI to…
Brainstorm 20 post ideas for your pillars	Invent experiences, clients or results you do not have
Turn your rough notes into a clear structure	Publish a post you have not read and edited
Suggest 5 hooks and pick or adapt the best	Write comments automatically on other people’s posts
Shorten, simplify, check grammar in English and French	Copy a famous creator’s style or content
Translate your About section, then check it	Generate a fake "professional" photo that does not look like you
Review your profile against a job description	Paste confidential client or employer data into a public tool

A voice brief for yourself

Create a short "my voice" brief (Week 13, Section 10 used the same idea for brands) and paste it into a Project, custom GPT or Gem so that every draft starts from your style.

```
CONTEXT: I am Anjali, a junior digital marketer in Mauritius (ex-banking,
DMM & AI Bootcamp 2026). Audience: marketing managers and SME owners.
My voice: clear, warm, practical, a bit of humour, no jargon, no hype.
I never use: "game-changer", "unlock", "dive into", emojis in every line.
ACTION: Turn my notes below into a LinkedIn post.
RESULT: 120-180 words, hook in line 1, short paragraphs, end with one
question. Do not add facts, numbers or claims that are not in my notes.
EXAMPLE: [paste one of your own posts that you liked]
MY NOTES: [your raw notes: what happened, numbers, what you learnt]
```

Keep it yours: the 4-check rule

1. **True:** every fact, number and example really happened (or is labelled as fictional).
2. **Mine:** it sounds like me; I would say it out loud in a meeting. Remove words you never use.
3. **Specific:** it contains at least one concrete detail AI could not invent (a place, a number, a real lesson).
4. **Checked:** names, tools, features and statistics verified; French reviewed by a fluent speaker if possible.

Disclosure

You do not need to label every post that AI helped edit, just as you would not label spell-check. But be transparent when AI created the main content or images: say "image created with AI" for generated visuals and never present AI-generated images of events, people or results as real. LinkedIn may show a content credentials label on images that carry AI provenance data. If someone asks whether you used AI, answer honestly; it is a skill employers value when used well.

> Recruiters and clients see many AI-written posts and profiles that all sound the same. The more your content relies on generic AI phrasing, the less it builds **your** brand. Use AI for speed; use your own experience for value.

PART D

Network and career

Networking in Mauritius, outreach, career paths, job search and freelancing as a business

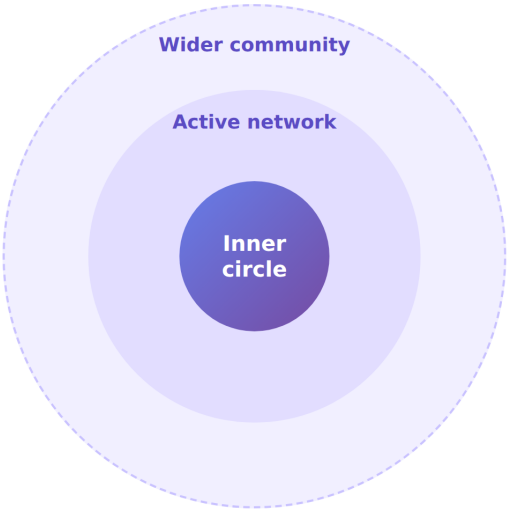
SECTION 19

Networking online and offline in Mauritius

Networking is not collecting business cards. It is building relationships where people know what you do, trust you, and think of you when an opportunity appears. The rule that works everywhere: **give first, follow up, ask clearly**.

Your network in three circles

Give first, stay in touch, ask clearly



Inner circle (10–20 people)
Mentors, former managers, classmates, clients. Talk every month. They recommend you.

Active network (50–150)
People in your niche you comment with and meet at events. Stay visible and helpful.

Wider community (hundreds+)
Followers, group members, event audiences. Your content reaches them.

Where to meet people in Mauritius

Type	Examples	Tips
Tech and digital community events	The free Developers Conference organised by the Mauritius Software Craftsmanship Community (MSCC) with GDG Mauritius (2026 edition: July, Moka); Google Developer Group and meetup events	Not only for developers: talks on AI, product and marketing; great for meeting tech companies
Business organisations	Mauritius Chamber of Commerce and Industry (MCCI), Business Mauritius, SME Mauritius, Economic Development Board events	Workshops, breakfasts and trade events where SME owners and managers attend
Training and alumni	Your DMM & AI cohort, Oreegami events, university alumni groups	Your classmates will work in agencies, hotels and banks: stay in touch
Industry events	Tourism, hospitality, retail and real estate fairs; agency talks; product launches	Go where your niche clients are, not only marketers
Online communities	LinkedIn groups and comments, Facebook groups for entrepreneurs and freelancers in Mauritius, WhatsApp communities	Help first; answer questions; never spam links

Check event dates on the organisers' own pages and LinkedIn; many events are announced only a few weeks before.

Before, during and after an event

When	What to do
Before	Look at the speakers and attendees on LinkedIn; pick 3 people to meet; prepare your 30-second pitch and 2 questions
During	Ask questions more than you talk; listen for problems you can help with; take a photo with speakers (with permission)
Within 48 hours	Send a personalised connection request mentioning the event; share a post with 3 lessons from the talks and tag speakers
Within 2 weeks	Follow up with something useful (an article, an introduction); suggest a coffee if relevant

Informational interviews

An informational interview is a 20-minute conversation where you ask someone about their job and industry, **not for a job**. It is the most underrated career tool, especially in a small market where one conversation can lead to three introductions.

- Ask people 2–5 years ahead of you (they remember being beginners) and a few senior people.
- Prepare 5 questions: "What does a typical week look like?", "Which skills matter most in your team?", "What do juniors get wrong?", "Which companies or people should I follow?", "Who else would you suggest I speak to?"
- Keep to time, thank them the same day, and tell them later what you did with their advice.

> **In Mauritius:** people are generally open to a coffee in Port Louis, Ebène or Moka, or a short video call, especially if you mention a common connection or the bootcamp. Be punctual and keep it short; respect their time and they will remember you well.

SECTION 20

Outreach message templates

Personalised, short and specific messages get answers. Generic "I would like to add you to my network" or long CVs pasted in a message do not. Adapt these templates; never copy-paste the same message to 100 people.

Connection request (up to 200 characters on a free account)

```
Hi Priya, I enjoyed your talk on hotel marketing at the MCCI breakfast
yesterday, especially the point on direct bookings. I would be glad to
connect. Kevin
```

After an online post

```
Hi Marc, your post on Meta Advantage+ results for retail was very useful.
I am a junior paid media marketer in Mauritius and follow your work.
Happy to connect!
```

Informational interview request

```
Hi Laura, thank you for connecting. I recently completed a digital
marketing bootcamp and I am exploring agency roles in performance
marketing. As an account director, your view would really help me.
Would you have 20 minutes for a short call or a coffee in Ebène in the
next two weeks? I will keep it to time. Thank you, Kevin
```

Referral or job enquiry (to someone you already know a little)

```
Hi Ashwin, I saw that your agency is hiring a Social Media Executive.
I have been following your client work for a while. In my bootcamp I
built a full social playbook and a Meta campaign plan for a restaurant
(case study: [link]). Would you be open to telling me more about the
role, or passing my profile to the hiring manager? Thank you!
```

Freelance outreach to an SME owner (French)

```
Bonjour Mme Lagesse, j'ai remarqué que votre restaurant publie de belles
photos mais n'a pas encore de fiche Google à jour. J'accompagne les
restaurants du nord sur Google et Instagram. Je peux vous envoyer 3
idées gratuites pour améliorer votre fiche, sans engagement. Cela vous
intéresse ? Bien à vous, Sandra
```

Follow-up (once, after 7–10 days)

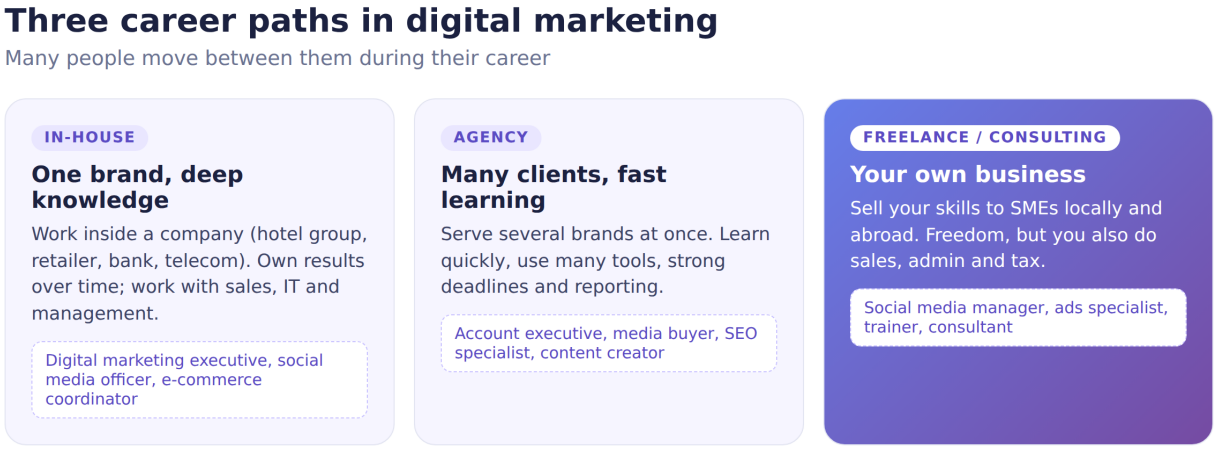
```
Hi Laura, just bringing this to the top of your inbox in case it got
buried. Completely understand if now is not a good time.
```

Send one follow-up only. Never add people to WhatsApp groups or mailing lists without consent, and never send mass unsolicited messages: it damages your brand and may breach the Data Protection Act 2017 and LinkedIn's rules.

SECTION 21

Career paths in digital marketing

The bootcamp promised a career pathway: in-house, agency or freelance/consulting. All three are realistic in Mauritius, and many marketers move between them. Choose a first step that matches your situation, not forever.



Common roles and what they need

Role	What you do	Key skills (bootcamp weeks)
Digital marketing executive / officer	Runs day-to-day digital activity for a brand	All-round: social, ads, email, analytics (1–15)
Social media manager / community manager	Content, community, reporting, sometimes ads	Content, social, AI content (4, 5, 13)
Paid media specialist / media buyer	Plans, launches and optimises ads	Google Ads, Meta Ads, display, ROAS (6–9, 12, 14)
SEO specialist	Technical, on-page and local SEO, content	SEO, websites, analytics (2, 3, 11)
Content marketer / copywriter	Articles, scripts, emails, landing pages in EN/FR	Content, email, AI (4, 10, 13)
CRM / email marketing executive	Lists, campaigns, automation, segmentation	Email, CRM, automation (10, 15)
Marketing / data analyst	Tracking, dashboards, insights	Analytics, Data Studio, ROAS (2, 11, 12)
E-commerce coordinator	Online shop, product pages, promotions, marketplace	Websites, ads, email, analytics
Account executive (agency)	Client contact, briefs, timelines, reports	Communication, planning, reporting
Freelancer / consultant / trainer	Sells services to several clients	Specialism + sales + business admin

Salaries vary widely by company, sector and experience. Check current job adverts, ask in informational interviews and look at salary surveys from recruitment firms rather than relying on rumours.

Which path first?

If you…	Consider
have little work experience and want to learn fast	Agency (many clients, tools, mentors)
have strong industry experience (banking, hotels, retail)	In-house in that industry: your domain knowledge is an advantage
already have a network of business owners and need flexibility	Freelance, ideally part-time first while employed
run a business	Apply the skills in-house to your own business, then consider services for similar businesses

SECTION 22

CV, applications and interviews

Your personal brand gets you noticed; your CV, application and interview get you the job. Make them consistent: the same positioning, the same results, the same photo and links.

CV basics (and ATS)

Many companies use an **ATS (Applicant Tracking System)**, software that reads CVs and helps recruiters filter them by keywords. To pass both the software and the human:

- **Simple layout:** one column, standard headings (Profile, Experience, Education, Skills, Certifications), no text inside images, no tables for key information. Save as PDF unless the advert asks for Word.
- **Keywords from the job ad:** if the ad says "Meta Ads, GA4, content calendar", use those exact words where true.
- **Length:** 1 page for juniors, 2 pages maximum for experienced people.
- **Profile summary** (3 lines): your brand statement adapted to the role.
- **Results with numbers** (Section 9), most recent first.
- **Links:** LinkedIn URL and portfolio at the top.
- **Mauritian practice:** many local employers still expect a photo, address and languages; include languages (English, French, Kreol, others). Personal details such as date of birth, marital status or ID number are not needed.

Applications that stand out

1. Apply where your positioning fits; 10 targeted applications beat 100 random ones.
2. Write a short cover letter or email: why this company (one specific detail), what you bring (two results), one idea for them.
3. Find the hiring manager or a team member on LinkedIn and send a short note after applying.
4. Track applications in a sheet: company, role, date, contact, status, next step.
5. Use local job portals such as myjob.mu and LinkedIn Jobs, company career pages and recruitment agencies; tell your network what you are looking for.

Interviews: prepare stories

Prepare 5 stories using **STAR** (Situation, Task, Action, Result): a success, a failure and what you learnt, a conflict, a time you learnt a tool quickly, and a time you used data to decide.

Common question	What they really ask	Prepare
Tell me about yourself	Can you communicate clearly? Why this field?	Your 60–90 s pitch (Section 5)
How would you promote our product?	Can you think strategically?	Audience → objective → channels → KPI → budget
Which metrics would you track?	Do you understand measurement?	KPIs and key events (Weeks 2, 11, 12)
How do you use AI in your work?	Are you efficient and careful?	One example with your quality checks
What are your salary expectations?	Are you realistic?	A researched range; ask about the package

Practical tasks (take-home tests)

Agencies often give a task: write 3 ads, audit a Facebook page, propose a campaign or analyse a dashboard. Keep a clean structure (objective, insight, recommendation, KPIs), respect the time limit and the brief, and present your thinking, not only the output. It is reasonable to ask how long the task should take; a very large unpaid task (a full strategy) is a warning sign.

SECTION 23

Freelancing and consulting in Mauritius

Freelancing means running a small business: finding clients, pricing, delivering, invoicing and paying tax. Start with one clear service for one type of client, and grow from there. Rules change, so confirm the current requirements with the official bodies before you start.

Registering (overview)

Step	What it involves	Where
1. Business registration	Register as a sole trader (individual) or a company and receive a Business Registration Number (BRN), which must appear on your invoices	Corporate and Business Registration Department (CBRD), online via the government business portal
2. Income tax	Declare your business income in your annual income tax return (deadline normally 30 September, a little later for e-filing with e-payment); quarterly payments (CPS) apply above certain thresholds	Mauritius Revenue Authority (MRA)
3. VAT	Compulsory VAT registration when taxable turnover exceeds Rs 3 million in 12 months (threshold since 1 October 2025); standard rate 15%	MRA
4. Social contributions	Self-employed people pay contributions (CSG) based on income	MRA
5. Other permits	Check if your activity needs a trade fee or licence from the local authority	Your municipal or district council

This is a general overview, not legal or tax advice. Rates and thresholds change with each Budget: check mra.mu and the CBRD, or ask an accountant.

Pricing your services (illustrative figures)

There are three ways to price. Beginners often start hourly and move to packages as they learn how long tasks take.

Method	How it works	Illustrative example
Hourly / daily rate	Rate × time spent	Rs 800 an hour; a 6-hour audit = Rs 4,800
Package (fixed price)	A defined deliverable at a fixed price	Google Business Profile set-up + 4 posts: Rs 6,500
Monthly retainer	Ongoing service each month, defined scope	Social media: 12 posts, 4 Reels, community management, monthly report: Rs 18,000 a month (ad budget paid separately by the client)

How to calculate a minimum rate

```
Monthly income you need (incl. tax, CSG, tools, savings):  Rs 45,000
Billable hours per month (not all hours are billable):      60 hours
Minimum hourly rate = 45,000 / 60 =                         Rs 750 per hour
```

Only about half of your working time is billable: the rest is sales, admin, learning and content. Increase prices as your proof and demand grow.

Proposals and contracts

- **Proposal (1–3 pages):** the client's situation and goal, your approach, deliverables, timeline, price, what is not included, next step.
- **Contract or written agreement:** scope, number of revisions, payment terms (for example 50% upfront), ownership of content and ad accounts (the client should own their ad accounts and pages), confidentiality and data protection, notice period.
- **Invoices** with your BRN, client details, description, amount, VAT if registered, payment details. Use juice or bank transfer; for foreign clients, check fees of international transfers and platforms.

Freelance platforms

Platform	How it works	Fees (check before signing up)
Upwork	Clients post jobs; you send proposals using "Connects"	Since May 2025 a variable freelancer fee per contract (0–15%); clients also pay a fee
Fiverr	You publish fixed-price "gigs"; buyers order them	Fiverr keeps 20% of each order
Malt	French-born marketplace popular with French and European companies; good for French-speaking marketers	Accepts freelancers registered in Mauritius; commission charged on missions
LinkedIn Services	Service page on your profile; clients request proposals	Free
Local network	Referrals, former employers, business associations	Free; often the best source in Mauritius

> **Tip:** platforms are crowded and price-driven. Use them for first reviews and international experience, but build your own brand and network so that clients come directly.

SECTION 24

Certifications to add

Free certifications from the platforms themselves are recognised by employers worldwide and show you keep learning. Add them to LinkedIn (Section 10) with the credential link, and renew them when they expire.

Certification	Provider	Cost	Notes
Google Ads Search, Display, Video, Shopping, Apps, Measurement	Google Skillshop	Free	Online exams; generally valid for 1 year, then renew
Google Analytics Certification (GA4)	Google Skillshop	Free	Matches Weeks 2 and 11
Meta Blueprint courses	Meta	Free to study	Self-paced e-learning on Facebook and Instagram ads
Meta Certified Digital Marketing Associate and professional exams	Meta (proctored exams)	Paid	Exam fee (around USD 99 for the Associate in the US in 2026); check the price for Mauritius before booking
Inbound, Content Marketing, Email Marketing, Social Media	HubSpot Academy	Most are free	Usually valid 1–2 years
LinkedIn Marketing Labs courses	LinkedIn	Free	LinkedIn Ads and Pages
DMM & AI Bootcamp certificate	Oreegami	Programme	Your main local credential: add it first

Which ones first?

Your positioning	Start with
Paid media	Google Ads Search, Google Ads Measurement, Meta Blueprint courses
Analytics	Google Analytics Certification, Google Ads Measurement
Content and social	HubSpot Content Marketing and Social Media, Meta Blueprint courses
Email and CRM	HubSpot Inbound and Email Marketing
Generalist	Google Analytics, Google Ads Search, HubSpot Inbound

Certificates support your brand; they do not replace proof. Five certificates and no projects look like theory only. One certificate plus one strong case study is more convincing.

PART E

Protect and measure

Online reputation, privacy, measuring your brand and your 90-day plan

SECTION 25

Online reputation and privacy

A personal brand makes you more visible, and visibility has risks: old posts, scams, oversharing, conflicts with your employer. Protect your reputation and your data from the start.

Clean up your digital footprint

1. Repeat the self-search from Section 3 and list every "red" result.
2. Delete or hide old public posts, photos and comments that do not fit (Facebook: Settings › Activity log; Instagram: archive).
3. Set personal Facebook and Instagram accounts to friends only or private if you do not use them professionally.
4. Close accounts you no longer use, or update them with your current photo and headline.
5. If a website shows wrong or harmful information about you, contact the site owner first; for personal data issues in Mauritius, the Data Protection Office can advise.

Separate personal and professional

Keep public (professional)	Keep private (personal)
LinkedIn profile, portfolio, professional posts	Family photos, children, home address
Your city and country	Exact location in real time, travel dates while away
Professional email, WhatsApp Business number	Personal phone number, ID number
Opinions on your industry	Strong political or religious debates, unless that is your field

Employer, clients and confidentiality

- Read your employment contract and social media policy. Do not share confidential figures, client names, internal documents or screenshots without permission.
- Talk about **lessons and methods**, not secrets: "How we reduced cost per lead" with percentages and no client name.
- If you post about your industry, add a line such as "Views are my own" where appropriate, and avoid criticising your employer or clients in public.
- For client work, the Data Protection Act 2017 applies to customer data you see: never post screenshots that show personal data.

Scams and fake opportunities

A more visible profile attracts more fake recruiters and "opportunities". Learn the warning signs:

Warning sign	What to do
Job offer that asks you to pay a fee or buy equipment	Never pay to get a job; check the company exists
Recruiter asks for your ID, bank details or OTP code early	Refuse; real employers ask for documents later through official channels
"Task" jobs paying for likes, reviews or crypto deposits	Scam: block and report
Message from "LinkedIn security" with a link to verify your account	Do not click; check in Settings directly

Warning sign	What to do
Profile with no history, stock photo, many connections abroad	Check mutual connections before replying

Handling criticism

Disagreement in comments is normal and can even help reach. Answer calmly, thank people for different views, correct factual errors politely, and do not reply to insults. If you made a mistake in a post, correct it openly ("Update: I got the date wrong, it is..."). Use Week 5's rules for negative comments on brand pages; they work for people too.

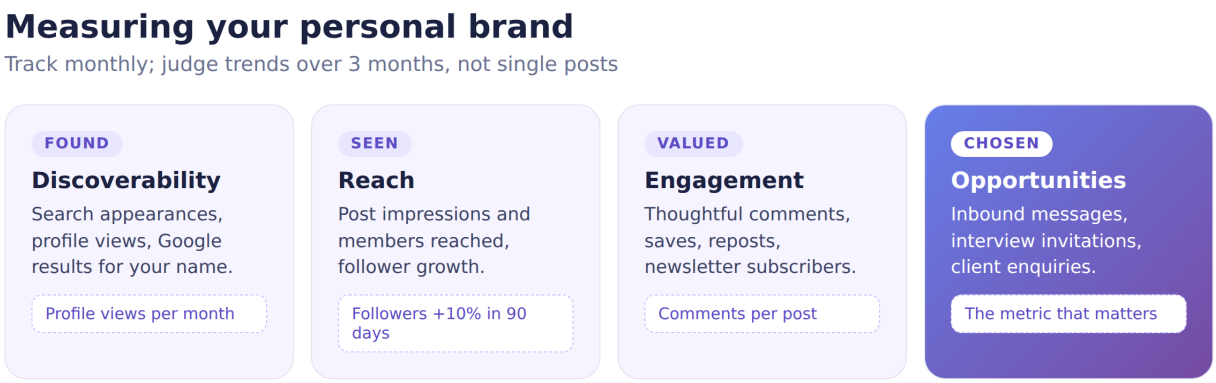
Security basics

- ☐ Two-step verification on LinkedIn, email, Facebook, Instagram and Google.
- ☐ A password manager; a different password for each account.
- ☐ Review the "Data for Generative AI Improvement" setting and third-party apps connected to LinkedIn.
- ☐ Back up your portfolio and certificates in a cloud folder.

SECTION 26

Measuring your brand and your 90-day plan

As with any campaign (Weeks 11–12), decide what success looks like before you start, measure monthly and adjust. The best metric is not likes; it is the number of real opportunities your brand creates.



Where to find your numbers

Metric	Where (LinkedIn)	What it tells you
Profile viewers	Profile › Analytics (or the "Who viewed your profile" page)	Interest in you; free accounts see a limited list of recent viewers
Search appearances	Profile › Analytics	Whether your headline and skills match what people search
Post impressions and members reached	Profile › Analytics, or "View analytics" under each post	Reach of your content
Comments from target audience	Your posts (count manually)	Whether the right people engage
Inbound opportunities	Your own tracking sheet	Messages, interview invites, client enquiries, speaking invitations
Google results for your name	Monthly incognito search	How you look to someone checking you

A monthly brand dashboard (illustrative numbers)

Metric	Month 0	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3	Target
Followers	180	240	310	395	+100% in 90 days
Profile views (per month)	25	90	140	170	150+
Search appearances (per week)	12	30	41	48	40+
Posts published	0	12	12	10	3 a week
Average comments per post	–	4	7	9	5+
Inbound opportunities	0	1	3	4	3+ a month

Growth rate = (new value − old value) ÷ old value × 100. Followers from 180 to 395 = (395 − 180) ÷ 180 × 100 ≈ 119% growth.

Your 90-day plan

Three phases: **days 1–30** foundations (be ready to be found), **days 31–60** visibility (show up every week), **days 61–90** opportunities (turn attention into interviews, clients and offers).

Weeks	Actions	Done when
1–2	Self-audit, feedback from 5 people, positioning, brand statement, pitch	Statement written and tested on 3 people
3–4	LinkedIn: photo, banner, headline, About (EN/FR), experience, skills, certificates, Featured; 2 recommendations; portfolio with 3 case studies	Profile checklist complete; portfolio live
5–8	4-week content plan: 12 posts; 15 min of comments a day; 50 targeted connections; 1 event	Plan done; tracking sheet updated weekly
9–13	Review analytics, keep best formats; 5 informational interviews; 10 targeted applications or client conversations; consider a newsletter	Interviews or proposals sent
Day 90	Full review against targets; plan the next 90 days	New targets set

> **Tip:** block two time slots in your calendar every week: 90 minutes on Sunday for writing and design, and 15 minutes every weekday morning for comments and messages. Consistency matters more than talent.

PART F

Put it to work

Three case studies, FAQ, your Personal Brand Strategy, worksheets, checklists, glossary

SECTION 27

Case studies: three personal brands

Three fictional but realistic people, each with a different goal. Their numbers are illustrative. Notice that none of them became "famous": they became known by the right few hundred people.

1. Anjali, career changer (Quatre Bornes)

Ex-bank customer adviser, 29, finished the DMM & AI bootcamp. Goal: a junior paid-media role within 4 months.

	Before	What she did	After 90 days
Positioning	"Banking professional"	Niche: paid ads and analytics for finance and insurance brands	Clear headline with keywords
Profile	Old photo, no About, bank job only	New photo, banner, EN About, bootcamp projects, 4 certificates (Google Ads Search, Measurement, GA4, HubSpot Inbound)	Search appearances ×4
Portfolio	None	Notion site with 3 case studies (fictional businesses, clearly labelled)	Linked in Featured and CV
Content	Never posted	3 posts a week: career-change story, GA4 explainers, "what banks could do better online"	310 followers (from 140)
Network	Mostly bank colleagues	6 informational interviews; Developers Conference; MCCI workshop	2 referrals
Result	–	12 targeted applications	4 interviews, 1 offer: digital marketing executive in an insurance company

Key lesson: her banking background became a strength once she chose a niche where it mattered.

2. Jean-Marc, business owner (guesthouse, Trou aux Biches)

Owner of a fictional 12-room guesthouse. Goal: more direct bookings and partnerships through his own credibility.

- **Positioning:** "Host and storyteller of the north coast": tips about the area, behind the scenes, honest lessons of running a guesthouse.
- **Profile:** headline "Guesthouse owner in Trou aux Biches | Slow travel in the north of Mauritius | Partnerships with tour operators"; About in English and French.
- **Content:** 2 LinkedIn posts a week (tourism industry, lessons) and the same stories adapted to Instagram Reels for travellers.
- **Network:** tour operators, DMCs, travel journalists, two tourism events.
- **Results (6 months, illustrative):** 3 new partnerships with European tour operators, an interview in a travel blog, direct bookings up from 30% to 38% of the total.

Key lesson: for a business owner, the personal brand is a trust engine for the business; the person makes the brand human.

3. Sandra, freelancer (social media, Curepipe)

Former retail shop manager, bilingual. Goal: replace her salary with freelance income within 12 months.

Step	Action
Niche	Social media and Meta Ads for restaurants and cafés, in French and English

Step	Action
Offer	3 packages: Starter (Google Business Profile + 8 posts, Rs 9,500), Growth retainer (Rs 18,000/month), Ads management (Rs 12,000/month + ad budget); all illustrative
Brand	LinkedIn for agencies and partners; Instagram showing before/after; Services page; Malt profile for French clients
Proof	2 restaurants at a reduced rate in exchange for a case study and a recommendation
Admin	Registered with a BRN, simple contract and invoice template, separate bank account, money set aside for tax
Results (illustrative)	Month 6: 4 retainer clients; month 12: 7 clients and white-label work for an agency

Key lesson: a narrow niche made referrals easy: restaurant owners talk to other restaurant owners.

SECTION 28

Frequently asked questions

I am shy. Do I really have to post?

No one has to. But visible work creates opportunities. Start with comments, then one post a week about what you learnt. Writing is a great channel for quiet people.

My employer might not like me posting. What should I do?

Read the social media policy, talk to your manager, and focus on learning and industry topics rather than internal matters. Many employers appreciate staff who represent the field well.

English or French?

Follow your audience. English for most recruiters and international clients, French for French-speaking clients and Réunion. A second language profile and some bilingual posts cover both.

How long before I see results?

Profile improvements show in search appearances within weeks. Content and network usually need 2–3 months of regular effort before opportunities appear.

Should I pay for LinkedIn Premium?

Not at the start. Free features are enough for a strong profile and content. Consider a trial during an active job search or sales push, and judge it by the opportunities it brings.

I have no real clients. What do I put in my portfolio?

Bootcamp projects, practice projects for fictional or friends' businesses (clearly labelled), and volunteer work for an NGO or association. Show your method and thinking.

Can I use AI to write my posts?

Use it to brainstorm, structure and edit. Make sure the experience, examples and opinions are yours, and check every fact (Section 18).

Should I accept every connection request?

No. Accept people relevant to your goals or who have a reason to connect. Too many random connections dilute your feed.

What if a post gets no reactions?

Normal. Check the hook, the topic and the time, then try again. Judge your strategy on a month of posts, not one.

Do I need my own website?

Not at first. A Notion, Canva or Google Sites portfolio plus a strong LinkedIn profile is enough. A domain like yourname.mu is useful once you freelance seriously.

SECTION 29

Exercises and capstone: Personal Brand Strategy

Your Week 19 deliverable is a **Personal Brand Strategy**: your personal branding strategy plus a 4-week thought-leadership content plan. Work on your real profile and goals.

Exercise A · Self-audit and brand statement (60 min)

Using Sections 3–5, send the feedback message to 5 people, complete the skills inventory, search yourself, then write your positioning statement, brand statement and a 30-second pitch in English (and French if relevant). Record your pitch on your phone.

Exercise B · LinkedIn optimisation (90 min)

Following Sections 6–11, update your photo, create a banner in Canva, rewrite your headline (3 options, choose 1), write your About section, rewrite two experience entries with results, add skills, the DMM & AI certificate and Featured items, and request 2 recommendations. Take "before" and "after" screenshots.

Exercise C · Content series (60 min)

Using Sections 13–18, choose 3–4 pillars, write and publish (or schedule) the first 3 posts of your plan, including one PDF carousel made in Canva. Use AI with your voice brief and apply the 4-check rule.

Deliverable: your Personal Brand Strategy

Your strategy has 11 parts. The last column shows the guide sections that help you write each part.

Part	Content	Guide
1. Goals	Your 6–12 month career or business goal; 3 measurable brand targets	2, 26
2. Self-audit	Feedback summary, values, skills inventory, Google search findings	3
3. Positioning	Niche, audiences, positioning statement	4
4. Brand statement and pitch	One-sentence statement; 30-second pitch (EN, FR optional)	5
5. LinkedIn profile	Before/after screenshots; headline, About, Featured, skills, certificates	6–11
6. Portfolio	Link to portfolio with at least 2 case studies	12
7. Content strategy	Audience, pillars, formats, rhythm, voice brief, AI rules	13–16, 18

Part	Content	Guide
8. 4-week content plan	12 posts: date, pillar, format, hook, goal/CTA; first 3 posts written	17
9. Networking plan	20 target people/organisations, 2 events, 5 informational interviews, message templates	19–20
10. Career path	Chosen path, target roles or services, certifications to add, (freelancers) offer and prices	21–24
11. Measurement and 90-day plan	Dashboard metrics, baseline, targets, 90-day action plan	26

Format: Google Doc, Notion page or PDF, 6–10 pages plus the content plan as a table or sheet.

How it is assessed

Criterion	Points
Clear, specific positioning and brand statement based on the self-audit	20
LinkedIn profile optimised (evidence of before/after)	20
Portfolio with honest, well-structured case studies	15
Content strategy and 4-week plan: pillars, formats, hooks, consistency	25
Networking, career path and 90-day plan with measurable targets	15
Presentation, language and ethics (privacy, honest data, AI use)	5
Total	**100**

SECTION 30

Worksheets, checklists and glossary

Copy these templates into your own document. Fill them in during the exercises.

Worksheet 1 · Brand foundations

Question	Your answer
3 strengths (from feedback)	
3 values + proof	
Niche: skill + market	
Main audience (who changes my career?)	
Brand statement (I help… achieve… with…)	
Goal in 6–12 months	

Worksheet 2 · 4-week content plan

Wk	Day	Pillar	Format	Hook (first line)	CTA	Done
1	Mon					☐
1	Wed					☐
1	Fri					☐
2	Mon					☐
2	Wed					☐
2	Fri					☐
3	Mon					☐
3	Wed					☐
3	Fri					☐
4	Mon					☐
4	Wed					☐
4	Fri					☐

Worksheet 3 · Networking tracker

Name / organisation	Why them	How I met / found them	Last contact	Next step

Checklist: LinkedIn profile

☐ Custom URL; location; contact info; professional email.
☐ Clear, recent photo; banner 1584 × 396 px with your promise.
☐ Headline with role, audience and keywords (not just "Student").
☐ About: hook, what you do, proof, personality, call to action; top 5 skills.
☐ Experience with results; bootcamp projects shown honestly.
☐ Skills relevant to your niche; endorsements from people who know your work.
☐ DMM & AI certificate and platform certifications with credential links.
☐ Featured: portfolio, case study, best post.
☐ At least 2 specific recommendations.
☐ Open to Work / Services set the way you want; privacy settings checked.

Checklist: before you publish a post

☐ One idea, one reader; hook in the first line.
☐ Short paragraphs; readable on a phone.
☐ True, mine, specific, checked (Section 18).

☐ No confidential or personal data; images labelled if AI-generated.
☐ Clear question or call to action; 0–3 hashtags.
☐ Time blocked to reply to comments in the first hours.

Mistakes to avoid

- Posting for 2 weeks, then disappearing for 3 months.
- Copying viral formats and AI phrasing until you sound like everyone else.
- Talking only about yourself and never helping or commenting.
- Inventing or inflating results; sharing client data.
- Sending the same generic message to 100 people.
- Measuring success only by likes instead of opportunities.

Glossary

Key terms from this week, in alphabetical order.

Term	Meaning
ATS	Applicant Tracking System: software that stores and filters job applications, often by keywords
Banner	The background image at the top of a LinkedIn profile (1584 × 396 px)
Brand statement	One sentence that says who you help, with what result and how
BRN	Business Registration Number issued by the CBRD; must appear on invoices
Carousel (LinkedIn)	A PDF uploaded as a document post that readers swipe through
Elevator pitch	A 30-second spoken introduction of who you are and what you do
Endorsement	A confirmation by a connection that you have a skill
Featured	Profile section that showcases chosen posts, links and media
Hook	The first line of a post or first seconds of a video, designed to stop the scroll
Informational interview	A short conversation to learn about someone’s job or industry, not to ask for a job
Niche	A focused area of expertise and/or type of client
Open to Work	LinkedIn feature that tells recruiters (or everyone) you are looking for a job
Personal brand	Your reputation: what the right people know, think and say about you
Pillar	A recurring topic of your content that supports your positioning
Portfolio	A collection of case studies and work samples that prove your skills
Positioning	The specific place you want to occupy in your audience’s mind
Retainer	A monthly fee for an agreed ongoing service
STAR	Situation, Task, Action, Result: a structure for interview answers
Thought leadership	Sharing useful ideas and experience so people see you as a trusted source
Top Voice	Blue LinkedIn badge given by LinkedIn’s editorial team to selected experts